

under the GPL simultaneously receives the entire rights to read or modify the source code. The giver may decide to either give the software with the source code for free (as in “free beer”) or need that the recipient pay some fee. In either case, the giver has no right to restrict access to the source code. One of the most striking examples of the open source movement is the development of the Linux operating system. This was an open collaborative effort that saw a full-fledged operating system evolve out of a computer science student’s hobby.

6.2.10 Proprietary Systems

See Closed Source.

6.2.11 Systems Software

In addition to the core files that make up the operating system, there are a number of files and programs that are considered “part” of the operating system. These include software libraries of functions, system services, printer drivers, and other hardware, system preferences and configuration files—and much more. In contrast to applications, users have less choice as to what parts of the systems software should be installed. In general, systems software act as the first line of communication between the hardware and the software.

6.3 Programming

6.3.1 ActiveX

A technology from Microsoft used to view Desktop applications as Web content. For example, using ActiveX, you can view MS Word documents or Excel spreadsheets in your Web browser.

6.3.2 Array

Programmers sink their teeth into arrays when they need to organise data such that a related set of values can be easily sorted and searched. An array is essentially a data structure that contains a group of elements. Usually, the elements in the array are of the